FERNA SUNDAREE

Installation Guide for Windows

Install, update and remove Ferna Sundaree on Windows 10 and 11, for one person or a whole organisation.

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Ferna Software Solutions

Ferna Sundaree is free, open-source software (MIT licence)
github.com/tgi25/ferna-sundaree

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Quick start (most people)

1. Download **FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi** from github.com/tgi25/ferna-sundaree/releases.
2. Double-click it. If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
3. Click **Yes** when Windows asks for permission, then **Finish**.
4. Start **Ferna Sundaree** from the Start menu.
5. Optional: *Menu* → *Settings* → *General* → *Make default…*

CHAPTER 1

Before you start

This guide installs Ferna Sundaree 0.6.2 on Windows 10 or Windows 11, keeps it up to date and removes it again. It also covers installing it for a whole school or office.

System requirements

Item	Requirement
Windows	Windows 10 (64-bit) or Windows 11, with current updates
Processor	64-bit Intel or AMD (x64). Windows on ARM PCs run the x64 version through Windows' built-in emulation.
Memory	4 GB RAM or more (8 GB for many tabs at once)
Disk space	About 400 MB for the program, plus space for your browsing data
Rights	The MSI package needs an administrator's approval. The Setup program and the portable version do not.
Internet	Needed for browsing, the filter lists (blocking ads and dangerous sites) and updates

Choose a package

Every release comes in three Windows packages. They contain the same browser and differ only in where it is installed and who can use it.

File	Best for	Installs to
FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi Recommended	Most people, shared PCs, schools and offices. Installs for every user of the PC, appears in *Settings* → *Apps*, can be deployed with Group Policy or Intune, and upgrades itself in place.	`C:\Program Files\Ferna Sundaree`
FernaSundaree-Setup-0.6.2.exe	Your own account on a PC where you are not an administrator. You can pick the folder.	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\ferna-sundaree`
FernaSundaree-Portable-0.6.2.exe	Trying Ferna Sundaree without installing anything, or running it from a USB stick.	Nothing is installed; the program runs from the file

> **Install only one package**
>
> Use either the MSI or the Setup program on a PC, not both. They are separate installations and would show two entries in the Start menu. To switch, uninstall one first (Chapter 8). Your bookmarks, passwords and settings are kept.

Download the files

1. Open the releases page: **github.com/tgi25/ferna-sundaree/releases**.
2. Under the newest version, open **Assets** and download the package you chose, and also **SHA256SUMS.txt**.
3. Keep both files in your **Downloads** folder.

Check the download (recommended)

A checksum proves that the file you downloaded is exactly the file that was published. Open **PowerShell** (right-click Start → *Terminal*) and run:

```
cd $env:USERPROFILE\Downloads
Get-FileHash .\FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi -Algorithm SHA256
```

Compare the long **Hash** value with the line for the same file name in `SHA256SUMS.txt` (open it in Notepad). Capital and small letters do not matter. If the values differ, delete the file and download it again. Never install a file whose checksum does not match.

CHAPTER 2

The "Windows protected your PC" message

Windows SmartScreen warns about programs that are not yet signed with a paid code-signing certificate. Ferna Sundaree is open source and does not have one yet, so Windows shows **"Unknown publisher"** the first time you run an installer.

This warning does not mean a virus was found. It means Windows does not yet recognise the publisher. Check the checksum first (Chapter 1), then:

1. When the blue **Windows protected your PC** window appears, click **More info**.
2. Check that the app name is the file you downloaded (for example `FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi`).
3. Click **Run anyway**.

Some browsers also hold back downloaded programs. In Microsoft Edge, open the downloads list, point at the file and choose **⋯** → **Keep** → **Show more** → **Keep anyway**.

Why you can still trust the updates

After installation, Ferna Sundaree installs an update only if it is signed with the Ferna project's own private key. It also checks that the update's checksum matches the signed list (Chapter 7). A tampered download is refused, with or without a code-signing certificate.

Your antivirus program

Other antivirus products may also warn about a new, unsigned browser. If one moves the file to quarantine, check the checksum. If it matches, restore the file and add an exception for it.

CHAPTER 3

Install with the MSI package

The MSI is the standard Windows Installer package. It installs Ferna Sundaree for every user of the PC.

1. Double-click **FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi** in your Downloads folder. (If SmartScreen appears, see Chapter 2.)
2. The installer prepares, then Windows asks **Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?** Click **Yes**. If you are not an administrator, an administrator must type their password here.
3. Wait for the progress bar to finish (usually under a minute) and click **Finish**.
4. Start Ferna Sundaree from the **Start menu** or the new **desktop shortcut**.

What the MSI does

- Copies the browser to `C:\Program Files\Ferna Sundaree`.
- Adds **Ferna Sundaree** to the Start menu and the desktop.
- Registers Ferna Sundaree as a web browser and PDF viewer, so it appears in *Settings* → *Apps* → *Default apps*.
- Adds an entry in *Settings* → *Apps* → *Installed apps* for repair and removal.
- When you install a newer MSI, it replaces the older version in place and keeps all data.

Install quietly from the command line

Administrators can install without any windows. Run these in an **administrator** PowerShell or Command Prompt:

```
# fully silent
msiexec /i FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi /qn
# progress bar only, no questions, with a log file
msiexec /i FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi /passive /l*v "%TEMP%\ferna-install.log"
```

> **Downgrades are blocked**
>
> If a newer version is already installed, the MSI stops with “A newer version of Ferna Sundaree is already installed.” Uninstall the newer version first if you really need the older one.

CHAPTER 4

Install with the Setup program

The Setup program installs Ferna Sundaree for your Windows account only and does not need administrator rights.

1. Double-click **FernaSundaree-Setup-0.6.2.exe**. (If SmartScreen appears, see Chapter 2.)
2. Choose **Only for me** when asked, and click **Next**.
3. Keep the suggested folder, or click **Browse…** to choose another one. Click **Install**.
4. When it finishes, leave **Run Ferna Sundaree** ticked and click **Finish**.

The Setup program creates Start-menu and desktop shortcuts and registers the browser for your account in *Default apps*.

Silent installation

```
FernaSundaree-Setup-0.6.2.exe /S
```

Add `/D=C:\Path\To\Folder` as the **last** argument to choose the folder.

CHAPTER 5

Run the portable version

The portable version is a single program file. Nothing is installed, and it works without administrator rights.

1. Copy **FernaSundaree-Portable-0.6.2.exe** to any folder, or to a USB stick.
2. Double-click it. The first start takes a few seconds longer while it unpacks itself.

- It does not add Start-menu entries or file associations, and it cannot be chosen as the default browser.
- Your bookmarks, passwords and settings are stored in your Windows profile (`%LOCALAPPDATA%\FernaSundaree`), not next to the file. On another PC you start with an empty browser. Use **Sync** (see the user manual) to carry your data with you.

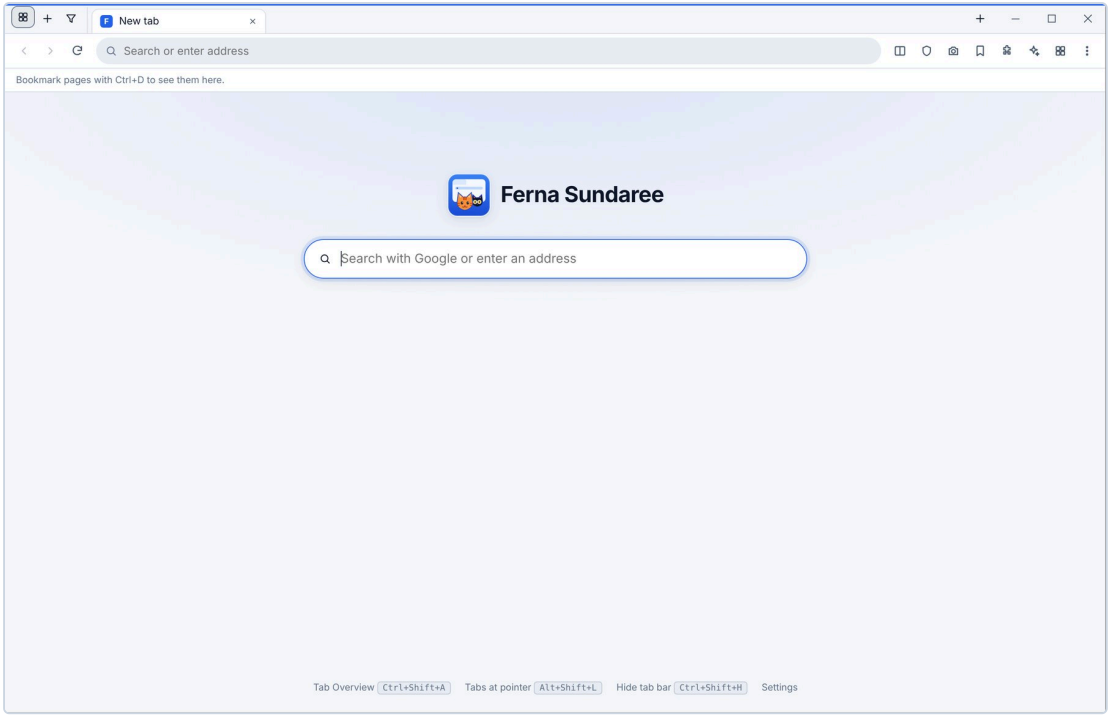
- When an update is available, *Settings* → *About* offers **Download update** and then **Save new version**. The checked new file is saved in your **Downloads** folder; use it instead of the old one.

CHAPTER 6

After installing

The first start

Ferna Sundaree opens with a new tab. On the first start it downloads the ad-blocking and safe-browsing lists in the background. Blocking becomes fully active within a minute.



Ferna Sundaree on its first start. Type an address or a search into the box, or press Ctrl + L to use the address bar.

Make it your default browser

Windows 10 and 11 do not let a program make itself the default. You choose it in Windows Settings:

1. In Ferna Sundaree open **Menu (⋮)** → **Settings** → **General** and click **Make default…**. Windows Settings opens at *Default apps*. (You can also open *Settings* → *Apps* → *Default apps* yourself.)
2. Click **Ferna Sundaree** in the list of apps.
3. On Windows 11, click **Set default** at the top. On Windows 10, choose Ferna Sundaree under **Web browser**.
4. Optional: in the same page, set **.pdf** to Ferna Sundaree to open PDF files in the built-in Ferna PDF Reader.

Bring your bookmarks and passwords

- **Bookmarks:** open *Menu → Bookmark manager* (Ctrl + Shift + O) and click **Import...**. Ferna Sundaree reads HTML bookmark files exported from any browser, Chrome/Edge/Brave `Bookmarks` files and Firefox `.json` backups.
- **Passwords:** export them as a CSV file from your old browser or password manager. Then open *Menu → Passwords and autofill* and click **Import CSV...**. Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari, Bitwarden, LastPass and 1Password exports are recognised. Delete the CSV file afterwards: it contains your passwords as plain text.

Windows features Ferna Sundaree uses

Feature	What to check
Windows Hello	Showing, copying or exporting a saved password, and filling a payment card, ask for Windows Hello (PIN, fingerprint or face). Set it up in *Settings → Accounts → Sign-in options*.
Microsoft Defender	Finished downloads are scanned with Microsoft Defender Antivirus when it is your active antivirus. With another antivirus, that product scans files itself.
Encryption	Bookmarks, history, the session and the password vault are encrypted with your Windows account (DPAPI). They cannot be read from another account or another PC.
Read aloud	Uses the voices installed in Windows. Add more in *Settings → Time & language → Speech*.
Spell check	Uses Windows' dictionaries. Add a language in *Settings → Time & language → Language & region*.

CHAPTER 7

Updates

Ferna Sundaree updates itself. It checks for a new version a minute after it starts and then every six hours. Chromium security fixes are released about once a week, so expect a small update most weeks.

Where updates come from

Ferna Sundaree asks GitHub and the Ferna update mirror at the same time and takes the newest correctly signed release, so updates keep arriving even if one of them is unavailable. An organisation can point all its PCs to its own server instead (policy **UpdateMirror**, Chapter 9).

How an update is checked

Every release carries a list of its files with their checksums, signed with the Ferna project's private key. The browser contains the matching public key. An update is installed only if:

1. the signature on the list is valid,
2. the version is newer than the one you have (it never goes back to an older version), and
3. the downloaded file matches the checksum in the signed list.

What happens for each package

Package	Update
MSI	Downloaded in the background. When it is ready, a message says so and the menu shows **Restart to update to x.y.z…**. Windows asks for administrator approval and the installer runs with a progress bar. Then start Ferna Sundaree again; with *Continue where you left off* on, your tabs come back.
Setup program	Downloaded in the background. **Menu** → **Restart to update** installs it silently and starts the browser again. No administrator approval is needed.
Portable	*Settings* → *About* shows that an update is available. Click **Download update**, then **Save new version**: the checked file is saved in your Downloads folder. Close the browser and run the new file.

Check now, or turn automatic updates off

Open **Menu** → **Settings** → **About**. Click **Check now** to look for a new version immediately. Switch **Update automatically** off if your organisation deploys updates itself. To update by hand, install the newer package over the old one. Your data stays in place.

CHAPTER 8

Uninstall

1. Close Ferna Sundaree.
2. Open **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps** (Windows 10: *Settings* → *Apps* → *Apps & features*).
3. Find **Ferna Sundaree**, click ⋯ → **Uninstall** (Windows 10: click it, then **Uninstall**) and confirm.

Command line (administrator, MSI): `msiexec /x FernaSundaree-0.6.2-x64.msi /qn`. The portable version is removed by deleting its file.

Remove your data as well

Uninstalling keeps your bookmarks, passwords, history and settings, so a reinstall picks up where you left off. To remove them for good, delete this folder after uninstalling. Press `Win` + `R`, paste the path

and press Enter:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\FernaSundaree
```

It contains one sub-folder for each profile (`Profiles\Default`, …) and the parental-control settings. Screenshots you saved stay in `Downloads\Ferna Screenshots`. Shortcuts made for installed web apps are under *Start menu → Ferna Sundaree Apps*, and you can delete them there.

> **This cannot be undone**
> Deleting the data folder removes saved passwords permanently. Export them first (*Passwords and autofill → Export CSV…*) if you might need them.

CHAPTER 9

For schools and organisations

Deploy the MSI

The MSI works with the usual deployment tools: **Group Policy software installation** (assign to computers), **Microsoft Intune** (line-of-business app), **Configuration Manager** or any tool that runs `msiexec /i … /qn`. Because each new MSI upgrades the old one in place, deploying a newer MSI is enough to update every PC.

Manage settings with Group Policy

Ferna Sundaree reads policies from `HKLM\Software\Policies\FernaSundaree` (and `HKCU\…`). A setting set by policy shows a lock in Settings and cannot be changed by users.

1. From the source package (`ferna-sundaree-0.6.2-source.zip`), copy `build\policy\FernaSundaree.admx` to `C:\Windows\PolicyDefinitions` and `build\policy\en-US\FernaSundaree.adml` to `C:\Windows\PolicyDefinitions\en-US`. In a domain, use the central store (`\\domain\SYSVOL\…\Policies\PolicyDefinitions`).
2. Open the Group Policy editor (`gpedit.msc` or the Group Policy Management Console) and go to **Computer Configuration → Administrative Templates → Ferna Sundaree**.
3. Set the policies you need. Ferna Sundaree reads them when it starts.

Policy	Effect
HttpsFirst, AdBlocker, SafeBrowsing, LookalikeWarnings	Force the main protections on (or off)
SearchEngine, DnsOverHttpsMode, DnsOverHttpsProvider	Default search engine and secure DNS

BlockThirdPartyCookies, FingerprintProtection, GlobalPrivacyControl, PopupBlocker	Privacy settings
EnhancedSecurity, ExtensionGuard, DefenderScan	Hardening: no JIT compiler, extension checks, download scanning
PasswordManager, AutofillAddresses, AutofillCards	Turn the password manager and autofill on or off
AutoUpdate, SleepingTabs, HistoryDays	Updates, memory saving, how many days of history are kept
UpdateMirror	Address (`https://…/`) of a folder on your own server with `update.json`, `update.json.sig` and the installers of a release. PCs then update only from there, still only with Ferna-signed releases.
AssistantAllowed, SyncAllowed, PrivateWindowsAllowed, TorWindowsAllowed, DeveloperToolsAllowed, WebAppsAllowed, ProfilesAllowed	Allow or remove whole features

Exam computers

For online exams, install the MSI on the exam PCs and give students a `.fernaexam` file. Double-clicking it starts the locked exam window. Creating exam files is explained in the user manual (Secure exam mode).

CHAPTER 10

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
“Windows protected your PC”	Click **More info** → **Run anyway** after checking the checksum (Chapter 2).
The installer says a newer version is installed	You already have a newer version. Use it, or uninstall it first.
The MSI asks for a password you do not have	Use the Setup program instead. It installs for your account without administrator rights.
Ferna Sundaree does not appear in Default apps	It is registered by the MSI and the Setup program, not by the portable version. Reinstall with one of them, then sign out and back in.
Downloads show no “Microsoft Defender: no threats” line	Microsoft Defender is turned off or another antivirus is in charge. That is normal; the other product scans the files itself.
“Windows Hello is not set up”	Set up a PIN in *Settings* → *Accounts* → *Sign-in options*, then try again.

A web page looks wrong or is blank	Click the shield in the toolbar and turn blocking off for that site. If that fixes it, the site needs an exception.
The browser does not start after an update	Install the latest MSI or Setup program again over the existing one. Your data is kept.
Start completely fresh	Close the browser and rename `%LOCALAPPDATA%\FernaSundaree\Profiles\Default` to `Default.old`. The next start creates a new, empty profile, and the old folder stays as a backup.

Command-line options

Option	Effect
`--profile=Work`	Starts the browser with the profile *Work*, which has its own bookmarks, passwords, cookies and extensions
`--app=https://example.com`	Opens a site in its own app window, without tabs or address bar
`--exam=C:\path\quiz.fernaexam`	Starts a secure exam from an exam file
an address or a file path	Opens it in a new tab (for example a PDF file)

Help and bug reports: github.com/tgi25/ferna-sundaree/issues. Please mention your Windows version and the Ferna Sundaree version from *Settings → About*.